

Subject: Submission: UK Retail Sales Analysis & Consumer Trends Dashboard – Henry Viyuyi

Dear Ms. Chama, Mr. Spratt, and Dr. Shale,

Please find attached my final Power BI dashboard and supporting documentation regarding the analysis of Retail Sales Trends and Consumer Spending in Great Britain (1996–2026).

Project Relevance

In the wake of global economic shifts, understanding the structural resilience of the UK retail sector is more critical than ever. This project leverages historical Office for National Statistics (ONS) data to evaluate how the industry transitioned from a traditional model to a modern, digitally integrated economy. This analysis provides actionable insights into market stability and the long-term impact of external shocks on consumer behavior.

Research Objectives

My primary objective was to uncover the narrative behind the numbers, specifically focusing on:

- The Digital Catalyst: Quantifying the "Online Bump" during the 2020 pandemic and determining if this shift represented a temporary fix or a permanent structural change.
- Sector Resilience: Analyzing why the Food Store category remains the primary anchor of the UK economy, maintaining significantly higher and more stable volumes than volatile sectors like Automotive Fuel.
- Market Shock Analysis: Investigating the "Deep" (the 2020 decline) in total sales to visualize the immediate impact of lockdowns and the subsequent "V-shaped" recovery.

Key Findings

The data reveals a market that has successfully "reset." While the 2020 pandemic caused a significant dip in overall volume, it accelerated Online Share to a new baseline of 10.7%.

Furthermore, the dashboard highlights that while discretionary categories fluctuate, the necessity-driven Food sector ensures the market's 5.4% YoY growth remains sustainable.

Thank you for your guidance, I look forward to your feedback on this submission.

Best regards,
Henry Sanderson Viyuyi.